# Lexical ranking excluding query itself: Methodology and Evidence

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**Status.** Post-run methodology reconstruction grounded in archived source and reports. This document is not an executed historical notebook.

## Research question

A prior case retrieval system must never return its own query as precedent. This isolates the validity correction from the neural model so its score can be compared with the uncorrected lexical fallback.

## Architecture and mechanism

The export removes self IDs before ranking and fills the seven slots with eligible lexical candidates from each query's pool.

## Measured result

| | |
|---|---|
| Scored submission | 1039896 |
| Codabench micro-F1@7 | 0.4017 |
| Archived local metric | not independently reported after correction |

Codabench micro-F1@7 rose to 0.4017 from the earlier 0.3680 lexical submission. The comparison also changes the export rule, so it should not be labelled a model-training gain.

## Limitations and next check

The score difference cannot isolate every other version change without the missing original ZIP. Local, pilot, and hidden metrics are deliberately kept distinct. A single scored run does not establish a causal architecture effect or statistical significance.

## Source and reproducibility

Original source modules: phase7_export.py, phase7_run.py. SHA-256 hashes, the original report, and the prediction ZIP receipt are in the companion provenance file. The explanatory notebook was written after the historical run; original execution output is never implied. Reproduction requires authorized course data, the Phase 1 parent weights/tokenizer, and the dependencies in the archived source.

## Documentation disclosure

AI assistance was used to organize the archived evidence and draft this explanatory document. All numerical claims above come from saved run records or the provided finished-submission screenshot; missing evidence is labelled as such.